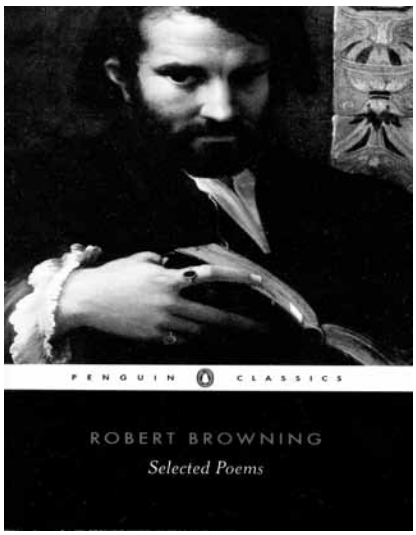
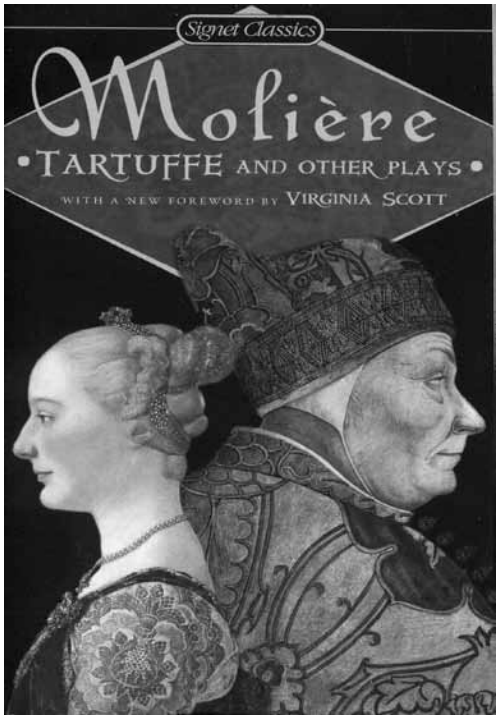
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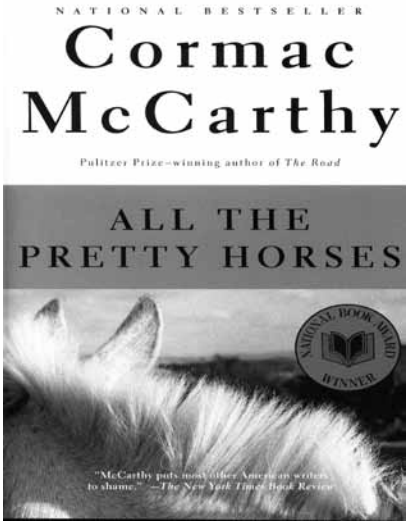
Making a World of Difference

Literary Criticism

District 1 • 2014







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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • District 1 • 2014

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. Words that by their sound suggest their meaning or, in succession through their rhythm and rhyme, contribute to an effect constitute

   A) amphigory.
   B) cacophony.
   C) consonance.
   D) melopoeia.
   E) onomatopoeia.

2. The term that denotes a fanciful notion usually expressed through an elaborate analogy pointing to a striking parallel between two ostensibly dissimilar things is

   A) apologue.
   B) conceit.
   C) euphemism.
   D) kenning.
   E) simile.

3. The linguistic principle that describes a complex of relations among consonants in Indo-European languages is

   A) the Baconian Theory.
   B) Freytag's Pyramid.
   C) Grimm's Law.
   D) Ockham's Razor.
   E) scribal error.

4. The genre of fiction describing an imaginary ideal world is known as

   A) dystopian literature.
   B) ecotopian literature.
   C) ectopian literature.
   D) subtopian literature.
   E) utopian literature.

5. The mid-twentieth-century American author whose novels include *As I Lay Dying*, *Light in August*, *Absalom, Absalom*, and *The Sound and the Fury* is

   A) James Fenimore Cooper.
   B) William Faulkner.
   C) Ernest Hemingway.
   D) John Steinbeck.
   E) John Updike.

6. The final unraveling, or unknotting, of a plot, the solution of a mystery, or an explanation or outcome of a narrative or drama is the

   A) climax.
   B) *débat*.
   C) *dénouement*.
   D) epiphany.
   E) peripety.

7. The period in English literature between 1100 and 1350, which is also often called the Early Middle English Period and is frequently dated from the Conquest in 1066, is known as the

   A) Anglo-Norman Period.
   B) Anglo-Saxon Period.
   C) Middle English Period.
   D) Old English Period.
   E) Renaissance Period.

8. The recently deceased Irish poet, playwright, and translator of *Beowulf* who was awarded the 1995 Nobel Prize for Literature is

   A) Oliver Goldsmith.
   B) Seamus Heaney.
   C) James Joyce.
   D) Jonathan Swift.
   E) William Butler Yeats.

9. **Not** a verse form whose tone suggests praise or celebration is the

   A) aubade.
   B) blazon.
   C) dirge.
   D) epithalamium.
   E) paean.

10. The placing of a sentence element out of its normal position in order, in verse, to accommodate rhyme and meter is called

    A) enjambment.
    B) inversion.
    C) litotes.
    D) metathesis.
    E) parenthesis.

11. To expurgate a piece of writing by omitting material considered offensive or indecorous, especially to female modesty, as demonstrated in some early nineteenth-century editions of Shakespeare's plays, is to

A) abridge.
B) bowdlerize.
C) double bill.
D) quibble.
E) truncate.

12. The poet and author of *The Bell Jar* who received, posthumously, the 1982 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry is

A) Carol Kizer.
B) Lisel Mueller.
C) Mary Oliver.
D) Sylvia Plath.
E) Anne Sexton.

13. A cheaply produced paperbound novel or novelette of mystery, adventure, or violence popular in the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries in England is the

A) dime novel.
B) gothic novel.
C) penny dreadful.
D) potboiler.
E) pulp magazine.

14. A figure of speech in which the literal sense of what is said falls detectably short of the magnitude of what is being talked about is

A) ambiguity.
B) amphiboly.
C) demotion.
D) litotes.
E) understatement.

15. Authors, including James Fenimore Cooper, Bret Harte, Mark Twain, Horace Greeley, Hamlin Garland, Larry McMurtry, and Cormac McCarthy, whose writings address life in the United States during westward expansion are contributors to the genre known as

A) Frontier Literature.
B) Local Color Writing.
C) metafiction.
D) Native American Literature.
E) Popular Literature.

16. **Not** one of the periods in the American canon during which writers and other artists were influenced by the great sectional and social problems that soon became so much a part of the fabric of this nation is the

A) Federalist Age.
B) Naturalistic and Symbolistic Period.
C) Postmodern Period.
D) Realistic Period.
E) Romantic Period.

17. The recipient of the 2008 Pulitzer Prize for Drama for his *"August: Osage County"* is

A) Edward Albee.
B) David Auburn.
C) Charles Fuller.
D) Tracy Letts.
E) Neil Simon.

18. The English Renaissance playwright who gave us, among many others, *The Tragedy of King Lear*, *A Midsummer Night's Dream*, *Richard III*, and *Coriolanus*, is

A) Ben Jonson.
B) Thomas Kyd.
C) Christopher Marlowe.
D) William Shakespeare.
E) Edmund Spenser.

19. The figure of speech, or trope, in which a part signifies the whole or the whole signifies the part is

A) antithesis.
B) elision.
C) hypallage.
D) parenthesis.
E) synecdoche.

20. The seventeenth-century New England Puritan minister and magistrate at the Salem Witch Trials who wrote *Memorable Providences*, *Wonders of the Invisible World*, *Death Made Easy and Happy*, *Magnalia Christi Americana*, and *Essays to Do Good* is

A) Cotton Mather.
B) Increase Mather.
C) Thomas Merton.
D) Thomas Morton.
E) Michael Wigglesworth.

21. A form of irony, a pretended refusal that is insincere or hypocritical, the best known example being, perhaps, Caesar's refusal of the crown, as reported by Casca, in Shakespeare's *Julius Caesar,* is

A) accismus.
B) antiphrasis.
C) epitrope.
D) litotes.
E) paraleipsis.

22. The recipient of the 1966 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction, author of *Pale Horse, Pale Rider*, *Ship of Fools*, and *The Old Order: Stories of the South,* is

A) Geraldine Brooks.
B) Shirley Ann Grau.
C) Toni Morrison.
D) Katherine Anne Porter.
E) Eudora Welty.

23. The term that is widely used to refer to a "second self" created by an author and through whom, in the case of prose, the narrative is told is

A) allonym.
B) eponym.
C) persona.
D) pseudonym.
E) putative author.

24. The genre of novel that places unusual emphasis on interior characterization and the motives, circumstance, and internal action that spring from, and develop, the novel's external action is the

A) epistolary novel.
B) novel of character.
C) novel of sensibility.
D) psychological novel.
E) sociological novel.

25. The period in English literature between the death of Victoria and the beginning of World War I is the

A) Augustan Age.
B) Caroline Age.
C) Edwardian Age.
D) Jacobean Age.
E) Victorian Age.

26. The fairly rare species of multiple rhyme (also called mosaic rhyme) in which typically one word is forced into a rhyme with two or more words is called

A) amphisbaenic rhyme.
B) broken rhyme.
C) chain rhyme.
D) falling rhythm.
E) heteromerous rhyme.

27. A work or manner that blends censorious attitude with humor and wit for improving human institutions or humanity is

A) didacticism.
B) jeremiad.
C) repartee.
D) satire.
E) travesty.

28. The period in American literary history covering 1900 to 1930 that is known for, in part, the virtual birth of modern American poetry is the

A) Naturalistic and Symbolistic Period.
B) Period of the Confessional Self.
C) Postmodern Period.
D) Realistic Period.
E) Romantic Period.

29. **Not** one of the Waverly Novels written by the early nineteenth-century, internationally acclaimed Scottish innovator of the historical novel, poet, and playwright Sir Walter Scott is

A) *Ivanhoe*.
B) *The Pirate*.
C) *Quentin Durward*.
D) *Rob Roy*.
E) *Robinson Crusoe*.

30. The smallest unit of rhythm in verse is known as (the)

A) foot.
B) meter.
C) stress.
D) syllable.
E) syncopation.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-36 are associated with Molière's *Tartuffe, or The Impostor.*
Items 37-43 are associated with Cormac McCarthy's *All the Pretty Horses.*
Items 44-50 are associated with Robert Browning's poetry (selected).

31. In Molière's *Tartuffe* the most directly candid of characters, the one who declares early on that Tartuffe "knows his dupe and means to use him," is

A) Cléante.
B) Dorine.
C) Elmire.
D) Orgon.
E) Valère.

32. Orgon's reproof of Cléante, "Brother, you're talking like an atheist; / Your soul's been spattered with free-thinking grime. / I've warned you more than once, an ugly time / Awaits you if you will not change your mind," is characterized by

A) aphorism.
B) epithet.
C) euphemism.
D) hyperbole.
E) oxymoron.

33. "If Heaven is all that leads you to resist, / Such obstacles are easily dismissed; / Do as I ask, and set your mind at ease" constitutes a failed argument by

A) Damis to Flipote.
B) Orgon to Elmire.
C) Orgon to Mariane.
D) Tartuffe to Elmire.
E) Tartuffe to Dorine.

34. "I may be pious, but I'm still a man. / And at the sight of your celestial charms, / Reason and heart alike lay down their arms" is Tartuffe's sensualized response to

A) Dorine.
B) Elmire.
C) Flipote.
D) Laurent.
E) Mariane.

35. Thematically, Molière's comedy *Tartuffe* does **not** address

A) fidelity.
B) gullibility.
C) hypocrisy.
D) morality.
E) religiosity.

36. Orgon's admonition, "Listen to me: / You give yourself a lot of liberty, / My girl. I won't put up with it, I swear," is directed toward

A) Dorine.
B) Elmire.
C) Flipote.
D) Laurent.
E) Mariane.

37. In Cormac McCarthy's *All the Pretty Horses* the observation, "It's a sorry piece of business, son. But I think the way it is is the way it's goin to be," is made by Mr. Franklin to John Grady concerning the

A) funeral.
B) girl, Mary Catherine.
C) horse.
D) ranch.
E) saddle.

38. The characterizing "What he loved in horses was what he loved in men, the blood and the heat of the blood that ran them" serves to introduce

A) Jimmy Blevins.
B) John Grady Cole.
C) Wayne Cole.
D) Don Héctor Rocha y Villareal.
E) Lacey Rawlins.

39. The two-person game to which the hacendado Don Héctor challenges young John Grady Cole is a game of

A) billiards.
B) chess.
C) chinchón.
D) poker.
E) Russian roulette.

40. Rawlin's allusory taunt, "Are you ready, Annie Oakley?" is directed at

A) Alejandra.
B) Alfonsa.
C) Blevins.
D) John Grady.
E) Perez.

41. The central theme of fidelity is evident in Rawlins's sharing with John Grady, "Ever dumb thing I ever done in my life was a decision I made before that got me into it. It was never the dumb thing. It was always some choice I'd made before it," refers to
    A) whether to buy a knife.
    B) whether to cross the Rio Grande.
    C) whether to leave Blevins behind.
    D) whether to take the job at the hacienda.
    E) whether to throw a billfold up into the air.

42. A confluence of experience finds expression in the contentious statement "I'd of thought maybe the disappointments in your own life might of made you more sympathetic to other people," directed at
    A) Alejandra by John Grady.
    B) Alfonsa by John Grady.
    C) John Grady by Alejandra.
    D) Perez by John Grady.
    E) Rawlins by Blevins.

43. The significance of the hot pistolbarrel is
    A) historical.
    B) metallurgical.
    C) meteorological.
    D) penal.
    E) surgical.

Items 44-50 refer to Robert Browning's

Youth and Art

It once might have been, once only:
    We lodged in a street together,
You, a sparrow on the housetop lonely,
    I, a lone she-bird of his feather.

Your trade was with sticks and clay,
    You thumbed, thrust, patted and polished,
Then laughed "They will see some day
    Smith made, and Gibson demolished."

My business was song, song, song;
    I chirped, cheeped, trilled and twittered,
"Kate Brown's on the boards ere long,
    And Grisi's existence embittered!"

I earned no more by a warble
    Than you by a sketch in plaster;
You wanted a piece of marble,
    I needed a music-master.

We studied hard in our styles,
    Chipped each at a crust like Hindoos,
For air looked out on the tiles,
    For fun watched each other's windows.

You lounged, like a boy of the South,
    Cap and blouse—nay, a bit of beard too;
Or you got it, rubbing your mouth
    With fingers the clay adhered to.

And I—soon managed to find
    Weak points in the flower-fence facing,
Was forced to put up a blind
    And be safe in my corset-lacing.

No harm! It was not my fault
    If you never turned your eye's tail up
As I shook upon E *in alt*,
    Or ran the chromatic scale up:

For spring bade the sparrows pair,
    And the boys and girls gave guesses,
And stalls in our street looked rare
    With bulrush and watercresses.

Why did not you pinch a flower
    In a pellet of clay and fling it?
Why did not I put a power
    Of thanks in a look, or sing it?

I did look, sharp as a lynx,
    (And yet the memory rankles)
When models arrived, some minx
    Tripped up-stairs, she and her ankles.

But I think I gave you as good!
    "That foreign fellow,—who can know
How she pays, in a playful mood,
    For his tuning her that piano?"

Could you say so, and never say
    "Suppose we join hands and fortunes,
And I fetch her from over the way,
    Her, piano, and long tunes and short tunes?"

No, no: you would not be rash,
    Nor I rasher and something over:
You've to settle yet Gibson's hash,
    And Grisi yet lives in clover.

But you meet the Prince at the Board,
    I'm queen myself at *bals-paré*,
I've married a rich old lord,
    And you're dubbed knight and an R.A.

continued

Each life unfulfilled, you see;
It hangs still, patchy and scrappy:
We have not sighed deep, laughed free,
Starved, feasted, despaired,—been happy.

And nobody calls you a dunce,
And people suppose me clever:
This could but have happened once,
And we missed it, lost it for ever.

44. The overall tone of Robert Browning's "Youth and Art" is

A) caustic.
B) facetious.
C) nostalgic.
D) optimistic.
E) pessimistic.

45. Lines 25-28 address the hopeful possibility that the sculptor is observing the singer

A) dress.
B) knitting.
C) redecorate her apartment.
D) sing.
E) water her plants.

46. The rhyming of the multi-word "who can know" (line 46) with the single-word "piano" (line 48) is

A) amphisbaenic rhyme.
B) compound rhyme.
C) heteromerous rhyme.
D) leonine rhyme.
E) macaronic rhyme.

47. Lines 33-40 suggest that despite all of the signs of romance in the air, that neither Kate nor Smith

A) approached the other.
B) picked flowers for one another.
C) sang to each other.
D) shopped together.
E) threw things at each other.

48. Line 10 is characterized by

A) amphigory.
B) hyperbole.
C) onomatopoeia.
D) sigmatism.
E) synæsthesia.

49. The first-person persona of Browning's "Youth and Art" should be considered

A) clinically insane.
B) paranoid.
C) reliable.
D) suicidal.
E) unreliable.

50. The persona, perhaps not unwittingly, reveals in lines 41-48 an otherwise unapparent

A) disgust.
B) jealousy.
C) low self-esteem.
D) nonchalance.
E) resolve.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-54 refer to Edna St. Vincent Millay's

Oh, Oh, You Will Be Sorry for That Word

Oh, oh, you will be sorry for that word!
Give me back my book and take my kiss instead.
Was it my enemy or my friend I heard,
"What a big book for such a little head!"
Come, I will show you now my newest hat,
And you may watch me purse my mouth and prink!*
Oh, I shall love you still, and all of that.
I never again shall tell you what I think.
I shall be sweet and crafty, soft and sly;
You will not catch me reading any more:
I shall be called a wife to pattern by;
And some day when you knock and push the door,
Some sane day, not too bright and not too stormy,
I shall be gone, and you may whistle for me.

*** primp**

51. The form of St. Vincent Millay's poem is the

A) caudate sonnet.
B) English sonnet.
C) Italian sonnet.
D) Petrarchan sonnet.
E) Spenserian sonnet.

52. The word that he will be sorry for using is

A) book.
B) little.
C) prink.
D) reading.
E) wife.

53. The phrase "some sane day" (12), in which an adjective modifies a noun that logically it should not, is a(n)

A) idiom.
B) incantation.
C) kenning.
D) transferred epithet.
E) volta.

54. Explicit in the last four lines of the poem is

A) acquiescence.
B) reconciliation.
C) seduction.
D) threat.
E) unrequited love.

Items 55-59 refer to Pablo Neruda's

Brown and Agile Child

Brown and agile child, the sun which forms the fruit
And ripens the grain and twists the seaweed
Has made your happy body and your luminous eyes
And given your mouth the smile of water.

A black and anguished sun is entangled in the twigs
Of your black mane when you hold out your arms.
You play in the sun as in a tidal river
And it leaves two dark pools in your eyes.

Brown and agile child, nothing draws me to you,
Everything pulls away from me here in the noon.
You are the delirious youth of bee,
The drunkenness of the wave, the power of the wheat.

My somber heart seeks you always
I love your happy body, your rich, soft voice.
Dusky butterfly, sweet and sure
Like the wheatfield, the sun, the poppy, and the water.

55. The imagery governing the presentation that is Pablo Neruda's "Brown and Agile Child" is

A) auditory.
B) gustatory.
C) olfactory.
D) tactile.
E) visual.

56. The final stanza turns on a

A) conceit.
B) metaphor.
C) oxymoron.
D) paradox.
E) simile.

57. The poem, in addressing a young child at a distance, can be recognized as a(n)

A) apostrophe.
B) aside.
C) echo poem.
D) harangue.
E) soliloquy.

58. Lines 11-12 feature anthropomorphized

A) euphemisms.
B) flytings.
C) metaphors.
D) oxymorons.
E) similes.

59. In line 10, the phrase "in the noon" is (a)

A) hyperbole.
B) metonymy.
C) palindrome.
D) sigmatism.
E) tapinosis.

Items 60-65 refer to John Crowe Ransom's

Vaulting Oak

He is a tower unleaning. But how he'll break
If Heaven assault him with full wind and sleet,
And what uproar tall trees concumbent make!

More than a hundred years and a hundred feet
Naked he rears against cold skies eruptive,
Only his temporal twigs unsure of seat,

And the frail leaves of a season, who are susceptive
To the mad humors of wind, and turn and flee
In panic round the stem on which they are captive.

Now a certain heart, too young and mortally
Yoked with an unbeliever of bantering brood,
Observed, as an eminent witness of life, the tree;

She exulted, wrapped in a phantasy of good:
"Be the great oak for his long winterings
Our symbol of love, better than summer's brood!"

Then the patient oak, delivered of his pangs,
Put forth profuse his green banners of peace
And testified to her with innumerable tongues.

And what but she fetch me up to the steep place
Where the oak vaunted? A flat where birdsong flew
Had to be traversed, and a quick populace

continued

Of daisies and yellow kinds, and here she knew,
Instructed well by much mortality,
Better than brag in this distraught purlieu.*

***open area**

Above their pied and dusty clumps was he
Standing, sheer on his hill, not much soiled over
By the knobs and broken boughs of an old tree.

She looked and murmured, "Established there, forever!"
But, that her pitiful error be undone,
I knocked upon his house, a sorrowing lover,

And like a funeral came the hollow tone.
"The grand old fellow," I grieved, "holds gallantly,
But before our joy has lapsed, even, will be gone."

I beat more sternly, and the dolorous cry
Boomed till its loud reverberance outsounded
The singing of bees; or the coward birds that fly

Otherwhere with their songs when summer is sped,
And if they stayed would perish miserably;
Or the weeping girl remembering her dread.

60. The form of Ransom's "Vaunting Oak" is the

A) pantoum.
B) rondeau.
C) sonnet.
D) sonnet sequence.
E) *terza rima*.

61. The mixing of sensory reception in the phrase "birdsong flew" (line 20) is called

A) discordia concors.
B) malapropism.
C) spoonerism.
D) synæsthesia.
E) zeugma.

62. The use of a part to signify the whole as it occurs in line 10 is

A) conceit.
B) double entendre.
C) kenosis.
D) synecdoche.
E) zeugma.

63. The imagery in lines 16-18, arguably enhanced by consonance, chronicles the

A) change of season.
B) death of the tree.
C) hanging of antiwar banners on the tree.
D) suffering of the tree.
E) local outdoor revival meetings.

64. Lines 10-15 point to the young girl's

A) arboreal imagination.
B) innocent optimism.
C) mitigated pessimism.
D) troubled ignorance.
E) wariness regarding blinking.

65. The speaker's treatment of the towering, patient oak constitutes

A) barbarism.
B) humanism.
C) pathetic fallacy.
D) personification.
E) zoomorphism.

Required tie-breaking essay prompt on next page.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie.

Note well: Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided for this essay; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Robert Browning's "Misconceptions," and respond to the possibility that the poem addresses a woman's misconception that the persona's interest in her was serious.

Misconceptions

This is a spray* the bird clung to,
  Making it blossom with pleasure,
Ere the high tree-top she sprung to,
  Fit for her nest and her treasure.
  Oh, what a hope beyond measure
Was the poor spray's, which the flying feet hung to,—
So to be singled out, built in, and sung to!

This is a heart the Queen leant on,
  Thrilled in a minute erratic,*
Ere the true bosom she bent on,
  Meet for love's regal dalmatic.*
  Oh, what a fancy* ecstatic
Was the poor heart's, ere the wanderer went on—
Love to be saved for it, proffered* to, spent on!

a small branch bearing buds, flowers

lacking consistency, regularity

outer coronation garment

imagination

offered for acceptance

KEY

UIL Literary Criticism
District 1 • 2014

line arrows up ➔

1.	E	337
2.	B	104
3.	C	223
4.	E	492
5.	B	577
6.	C	135
7.	A	27
8.	B	601
9.	C	146
10.	B	257
11.	B	66
12.	D	605
13.	C	357
14.	E	490
15.	A	211
16.	A	195
17.	D	609
18.	D	532
19.	E	470
20.	A	541
21.	A	4
22.	D	603
23.	C	361
24.	D	388
25.	C	165
26.	E	232
27.	D	427
28.	A	316
29.	E	544
30.	A	204
31.	B	1.3.199
32.	C	1.5.314
33.	D	4.5.1481
34.	B	3.3.366
35.	E	
36.	A	2.2.274
37.	D	17
38.	B	6
39.	A	143
40.	C	48
41.	C	79
42.	B	229
43.	E	289
44.	C	
45.	A	
46.	C	232
47.	A	
48.	C	337
49.	E	
50.	B	
51.	B	442
52.	B	
53.	D	483
54.	D	
55.	E	
56.	E	445
57.	A	37
58.	C	294
59.	B	298
60.	E	475
61.	D	469
62.	D	470
63.	A	
64.	B	
65.	D	361

FOLD along the **three** longitudinal lines for ease in grading. ➔

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

DO NOT mark (cross out) actual **LETTER** answer; mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer to the *Handbook* 12e, to the Signet *Tartuffe*, to the Vintage *Pretty*, and to Penguin's Browning collection.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Robert Browning's "Misconceptions"

Literary concepts that **MIGHT** be used in a discussion of the misreads in Browning's "Misconception" include

alliteration,
analogue,
assonance,
consonance,
feminine rhyme,
imagery,
implied action,
masculine rhyme,
metaphor,
run-on line,
rhyme scheme,
tenor,
tone, and
vehicle.

The contestant should recognize immediately that the poem's title yokes the two stanzas in what is essentially **not** a comparison but a single set of comparisons. The first stanza offers an example from nature; the second stanza moves closer to the human realm in which the persona "wanders" (line 13), elevating the woman, who would be charmed by the persona's attention, to the level of Queen. Both comparisons (here, metaphors without an expressed tenor) address the manner in which the persona establishes a relationship and then wanders quickly on, perhaps to the next relationship.

Browning's lyric poem explores the psychology of someone who points, seemingly without compunction, to short-lived relationships in which the women apparently expect commitment: the spray "blossom[s] with pleasure," but **his** commitment is a "hope beyond measure"; the Queen's heart is "thrilled in a minute erratic"; however, it is her "fancy [imagination] ecstatic" that has set up an expectation not to be met.

It is the psychological aspect of Browning's first-person "Misconceptions" to which the contestant who has spent time with the dramatic monologues will be drawn. He or she might note the persona's brazen denial of responsibility in the lines pointed out above: "hope beyond measure" and "fancy ecstatic."